



India's entire lithium-ion cell demand is met through imports

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has received ACC-PLI (Advanced Chemistry Cells- Production Linked Incentive) yet.

India's two legacy lead-acid battery makers Amara Raja and Exide lost out on the ACC-PLI scheme but are moving ahead without government incentives.

Amara Raja plans to invest ₹9,500 crore to set up a 16 GWh cell capacity in phases by 2030-31.

"Our first 2 GWh cell gigafactory is expected to be commissioned in June next year," says Vikramadithya Gourineni, executive director, Amara Raja Energy & Mobility.

Gourineni admits that things have slowed down. "We are dependent on equipment suppliers outside the country. Qualified technicians are not able to easily come for installation and com-

missioning of equipment. It's a big challenge. It delays things quite a bit," he says.

"There is a bit of policy uncertainty and conditions from China. There have been export controls and restrictions on technology access. Our own tech partnership has not gone ahead. It's become an in-house effort. There have been some stumbling blocks," he adds.

► **India imports more than 90% of its rare earth magnets, primarily from China**

► **Its demand for rare earth magnets is about 4,000 tonnes, projected to double to 8,000 tonnes by 2030**

► **India has the world's third-largest rare earth reserves at 6.9 million tonnes, says the US Geological Survey**